

PATHSEEKER CAREER PASSPORT

Career Decision Workbook

A guided evidence-based process for turning a long list of possibilities into one practical next experiment.

BEST FOR

Students, graduates, and professionals comparing two to five career directions.

FORMAT

10-page workbook - write directly on a printed copy or duplicate the prompts into your notes app.

Discover what fits you best - then test it with evidence.

01 - DEFINE

Start with the decision

A useful career decision is specific enough to test. Name what you are deciding, your deadline, and what a good outcome means.

The decision I need to make is...

I want to make it by... because...

Decision rule

Do not choose a forever identity. Choose the next direction that deserves a low-risk test.

What would count as a confident decision?

02 - FIT

Values and constraints

Separate preferences from non-negotiable constraints. This prevents an exciting role from winning a comparison it cannot realistically pass.

Income and stability			
Location or remote work			
Schedule and flexibility			
Learning and growth			
Purpose and impact			
Health or family needs			

The tradeoff I am least willing to make is...

03 - PATTERNS

Run an energy audit

Look at actual weeks, not your idealized self. Energy patterns reveal the kinds of tasks and environments you can sustain.

	1 2 3 4 5	1 2 3 4 5	
	1 2 3 4 5	1 2 3 4 5	
	1 2 3 4 5	1 2 3 4 5	
	1 2 3 4 5	1 2 3 4 5	
	1 2 3 4 5	1 2 3 4 5	

Patterns I notice about people, pace, problems, and environment...

04 - OPTIONS

Build a career shortlist

Choose three options that are different enough to teach you something. Include one adjacent role that uses skills you already have.

Option A		
Option B		
Option C		

- ☐ I reviewed real job descriptions.
- ☐ I checked entry requirements in my location.
- ☐ I spoke to or watched a credible practitioner.
- ☐ I can name one task I would do weekly in this role.

Which option is based most on assumptions?

05 - EVIDENCE

Compare evidence, not labels

Rate each factor from 1 (poor evidence or fit) to 5 (strong evidence or fit). Add a note so the score remains explainable.

Interest in daily tasks			
Current skill overlap			
Learning time and cost			
Local opportunity			
Income and stability			
Work environment fit			
Values and impact			
Evidence quality			

What evidence would change the ranking?

06 - REALITY

Reality-check the work

Job titles hide variation. Investigate the work, context, and hiring bar for a specific market and employer type.

What are the three most common tasks?		
What is stressful or repetitive?		
What gets measured?		
Which tools are common?		
What does entry-level evidence look like?		
What local license or degree is required?		

Ask a practitioner

What surprised you after joining this field, and what do candidates usually misunderstand about the work?

07 - TEST

Design three small experiments

A good experiment is short, produces evidence, and exposes you to a real task or person from the field.

Mini project	3-8 hours	Artifact or case note	I wanted to improve it
Career conversation	20 minutes	Answers and referrals	Daily work still fits
Job-posting sample	30 minutes	Skill frequency list	Gap feels learnable

My next experiment, first step, and calendar date...

08 - DECIDE

Make the decision transparent

Use a weighted score only to reveal your reasoning. Never let a total hide a serious constraint or regulated requirement.

Daily task fit				
Current evidence				
Opportunity and outlook				
Time and cost to enter				
Lifestyle and values				
TOTAL				

My provisional decision and the evidence behind it...

The condition that would make me revisit it...

09 - ACT

Commit to a 30-day action plan

Convert a decision into scheduled, observable steps. Small completed evidence beats a perfect plan.

1			
2			
3			
4			

The first action I will complete in the next 48 hours...

Sources and responsible use

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics - Occupational Outlook Handbook

Occupation duties, education, 2024 pay, and 2024-2034 outlook reference data.

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/>

O*NET OnLine

Detailed occupation tasks, knowledge, skills, work activities, and technology examples.

<https://www.onetonline.org/>

CareerOneStop

Career exploration, training, job-search, and local salary research tools.

<https://www.careeronestop.org/>

Important

Career requirements, salaries, and hiring practices vary by country, city, employer, experience, and economic conditions. Use occupational data as a research starting point, not a promise of employment or pay.